Keep Your Google Account Safe

A one-page guide for protecting your email, and what to do if something goes wrong.

If you think you've been hacked: do these now

1. **Don't panic, and don't reply** to any strange emails sent from your account.
2. On a device you trust, go to **myaccount.google.com** and **change your password** to a long, new one.
3. Open **Security > Your devices** and **sign out** of any device you don't recognize.
4. Check **Security > How you sign in**. Make sure the phone number and recovery email are yours.
5. **Call your bank or card company** if you see charges you didn't make, especially gift cards.
6. **Tell friends and family** not to open recent emails from you.
7. **Contact your IT helper** so they can check for anything the hacker left behind.

Everyday habits

- **Check the sender.** Look at the full email address, not just the name.
- **Hover before you click.** Rest your mouse on a link to see where it really goes.
- **Check the address bar.** A real Google sign-in page starts with **accounts.google.com**.
- **Use long passwords.** 14+ characters, or 4 random words: *cactus-lantern-orbit-maple*.
- **One password per account.** Let your password manager create and remember them.
- **Don't save credit cards in your browser.**
- **Keep 2-Step Verification on**, and set up passkeys when Google offers them.
- **Report spam** with Gmail's Report button. Don't click "unsubscribe" on suspicious emails.
- **Keep devices updated**, and install updates when prompted.
- **Once every 3 months:** run Google's Security Checkup at **myaccount.google.com/security-checkup**.

If an email asks you to sign in, don't use its link. Open the website or app yourself.

Google will never ask for your password or verification code by email, text or phone call.